

Astronomical Commentary

I spent all day casting. I haven't depleted this much magic since grad school. I keep telling myself I have a task at hand but I am sick of *walking* everywhere. By my calculations I have one more week of wards before this tower is truly secure and I can start to declare myself. Clearing back the ash trees has taken much of my focus, but at least now I sit on quite a sizable stockpile of firewood and building materials. Enough wood to transmute into a new tower story should I so choose. I also found enough incense in the Hold to resummon Frankie so at least I can talk to my bird after dinner.

I now spend the better part of my evenings reacquainting myself with the heavens. Even with the tower tilted askew, one of the upper chambers still grants a respectable sliver of sky. I find myself remembering when my father taught me the new constellations: The Sickie, The Scales, The Heroine, Celebrandt's Hound. He was old enough to remember the other ones. Nonetheless we live in the here and now and cannot dwell on what was lost.

This land has wandering stars; the dull grey one slow and stolid as ever, the rust-colored beacon that descends just after sunset and its pale blue complement that heralds the morning, and, of course, that white wanderer which shines even during the day. I made a few notations in my margin—nothing elaborate, just a quick calculation for their next alignment. Out here, far from the city, I'm struck by just how bright they are, the patterns of their wax and wane. They seem communicative. What if you could bounce a message off of one? I guess without the Conservatory's watch on me I could try to peer with eyes arcane. Not now, I need to regain my strength and fulfil my end of this deal.